

disrupting your production networks. You get to keep the box for two weeks and carry out your own testing, experimentation and exploration of Ubuntu's rich ecosystem of cloud tools. We will join you again, a couple of weeks later, to review what you learned and discuss scaling these tools into your own data centre, onto your own enterprise hardware."

The 16.8 kg box features 16 GB of DDR RAM, 10 four-core nodes and 120 GB of SSD storage. It will have an Intel i5-3427U CPU, an Intel HD4000 GPU and an Intel Gigabit network interface card (NIC). Built by Tranquil PC, the Orange Box can deploy OpenStack, Cloud Foundry and Hadoop workloads.

No more Cinnamon for Ubuntu users!

The popular Cinnamon PPA desktop environment for Ubuntu is going to be discontinued soon. According to reports, Gwendal Le Bihan, maintainer of the desktop environment, has announced that there will be no more stable releases.

Bihan wrote: "The stable PPA is indeed no longer being maintained. The nightly PPA is being kept for development purposes and should not be used on any sort of production machine (it can and will break at any time). To be honest, I don't have an alternative to offer Ubuntu users at the moment, apart from switching to a distribution that does support Cinnamon. There are many such distributions out there, and I'm only hoping for someone to (finally) step up on Ubuntu's side to provide proper packages to its users."

Google invites developers to submit Android Wear apps

Google has finally invited developers to take a shot at the new Android Wear platform. As the company's I/O Developer Conference for this year approaches, Google has invited them to submit apps for the platform for feedback. Android Wear is Google's platform for wearable devices, which will be showcased first on LG's G Watch and Motorola's Moto 360 smartwatches.

In a tweet sent out by the company, the search giant wrote, "Have you created an app you'd like to get in the hands of #AndroidWear users? We'd like to see what you've built!..."

Android Wear platform is a custom version of Android, which is tailored for wearable devices. The operating system was launched shortly after Samsung moved to its Tizen operating system for its new Gear smartwatches.



Ubuntu 12.10 Quantal Quetzal is no longer supported

Following 18 months of official support, Canonical has finally pulled the curtains down on Ubuntu 12.10 Quantal Quetzal. Ubuntu 12.10 is no longer supported, so users are advised to upgrade to Ubuntu 14.04 via Ubuntu 13.10.

Ubuntu 12.10 was released on October 18, 2012. Canonical founder, Mark Shuttleworth, had announced that Ubuntu 12.10 would be named Quantal Quetzal on April 23, 2012, and it was the first of a series of three releases before the next LTS release. Meanwhile, support for the 13.10 release will also end in July. As such, Ubuntu's latest release, 14.04 LTS, remains the only viable option for long-term Ubuntu users and its fan base.

Researchers discover first true Ransomware that attacks Android users!

A new Android malware has been discovered that can launch a full-blown ransom attack on a user's device.

According to reports, security firm ESET has discovered what is being called the first ever malware capable of encrypting data files on an Android smartphone, launching a ransom attack.

The malware, known as Simplocker, is a Russian-language Trojan that reportedly scans the SD card of a user's device or its internal storage, and encrypts data files with a range of extensions. This includes files with extensions .doc, .jpg, .avi and .mp4. It uses Stron 256-bit AES encryption to lock the files.



Reports say that the splash screen from the malware states, as translated from Russian, "WARNING! Your phone is locked! The device is locked for viewing and distribution of child pornography, zoophilia and other perversions." The malware then demands 260 Ukrainian Hryvnia (which is about £13 or \$9) that can be paid using MoneXy, in exchange for the stolen data.

According to ESET, the current prevalence of the malware is 'very low'. It is reportedly targeting Android in Russian-speaking countries, where the virus is contracted after downloading an app called 'Sex xionix' from a third party app store.